

Marble



Deep in the ground, far beneath our feet, the Earth is searingly hot and under great pressure from the weight of rock above it. So powerful are these forces, they can change rock from one type to another. They change limestone into marble.

Marble is one of the most beautiful rocks there is. It comes in many colours, including black, grey, green, and white, and it often has swirling patterns of other minerals running through it. You can polish it until it becomes super-smooth, and it's easy to carve, too. For all these reasons, marble is a popular choice for buildings and sculptures. It is heavy though – a cube of marble with sides 1 m (3 ft) long can weigh more than a rhinoceros.

*One of India's most famous buildings,
the Taj Mahal, is covered in white marble.*